DECODE UPSC with Mounika

Reel: Cancer medicines cheaper from today

Reading script · on camera · English + తెలుగు

Script

What if the same cancer medicine costs up to 70 per cent less, starting today?

ఇది నిజం!

Let’s decode.

From today, November 9, the National Pharmaceutical Pricing Authority has capped the trade margin on 137 anti-cancer medicines at 30 per cent.

But what is a trade margin? It is the cut taken by distributors and chemists between the company’s price and the price you pay. On these medicines it averaged about 170 per cent, and in some cases even 700.

ఇప్పుడు అది 30 per cent కి limit.

But which law allows this? Paragraph 19 of the Drugs Prices Control Order of 2013 lets the government step in on prices in extraordinary situations, in public interest, even for medicines outside the essential medicines list.

Prelims trap: the pricing authority does not work under the Health Ministry; it works under the Department of Pharmaceuticals, in the Chemicals and Fertilizers Ministry.

ఇది గుర్తుపెట్టుకోండి!

And this is not the first time: a 2019 pilot capped margins on 42 cancer drugs, and the prices of over 500 brands fell, some by up to 90 per cent.

Mains angle: Article 47 asks the state to improve public health, so is price control the answer, or will it hurt drug research?

మీ అభిప్రాయం comments లో రాయండి, and follow for one exam trap every day!

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Title:

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Cancer Medicines 70% Cheaper From Today? #UPSC #Shorts
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Description:

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From today (9 November 2026), trade margins on 137 anti-cancer medicines are capped at
30%, and some prices may fall by up to 70%. Here is everything UPSC can ask.

📌 Who: the National Pharmaceutical Pricing Authority (Department of Pharmaceuticals,
Ministry of Chemicals and Fertilizers)
📌 Law: Paragraph 19, Drugs (Prices Control) Order, 2013 (extraordinary situations,
public interest)
📌 Trade margin: the cut taken by distributors and chemists; it averaged about 170% on
these medicines
📌 History: a 2019 pilot on 42 cancer drugs cut the prices of 526 brands, some by up to
90%
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⚠️ Prelims trap: the pricing authority is NOT under the Health Ministry
✍️ Mains: Article 47 and public health: price control or drug research? Write your view in the comments!

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🧠 Quick test: Consider these statements:
1. The National Pharmaceutical Pricing Authority works under the Ministry of Health and Family Welfare.
2. From 9 November 2026, trade margins on 137 anti-cancer medicines are capped at 30%.
3. The cap was imposed under Paragraph 19 of the Drugs (Prices Control) Order, 2013.
How many are correct? (a) Only one (b) Only two (c) All three (d) None
Comment your answer! ✅ Answer: (b) Only two: statements 2 and 3 (the authority works under the Department of Pharmaceuticals, Chemicals and Fertilizers Ministry).